Unit 5



MINOR WOUND DRESSING

Definition:

Wound is a cut or break in the continuity of the skin. Cotton or gauze pieces are used to clean the wound. The dressing of the wound with dressing materials is called wound dressing.

Types of dressing:



Dressings may vary by type of material and mode of application. They should be easy to apply comfortably and made up of materials that promote wound healing.

- **Gauze dressing:** are the commonest. Gauze is available in different textures and shapes

  e.g. square, rectangle and rolls of various lengths

- **Non antiseptic dressings:** are sterile unmedicated dressings applied to a fresh wound to protect it from infection

- **Antiseptic dressings:** are impregnated with some medication and is applied to wounds already infected to limit the septic process

- **Wet dressings:** are used in infected wounds to soften the discharge, promote drainage and also in wounds that require debridement. It is also used to supply heat to the tissues. Moist heat is more penetrating then dry heat. Therefore moist heat is more beneficial in localizing the infection in an area. For applying wet dressing the contact dressing layer is moistened to increase the gauze ability to collect exudates and wound debris and then apply a dry second layer





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